



REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP) PROCESS

End-to-End Process Overview

Process Note: RFP Initiation & Execution Framework (IndiGo)

1. Preface – Initiation of RFP Process

This document outlines the standardized process to be followed by all departments initiating a Request for Proposal (RFP) within IndiGo.

The intent is to ensure:

- Alignment with Procurement, Legal, InfoSec, and Governance frameworks
- Adherence to defined timelines and compliance requirements
- Transparent and fair vendor evaluation

All departments are required to plan RFP activities in advance considering internal dependencies and approval cycles.

2. Legal & NDA Compliance (Mandatory)

As per IndiGo Legal guidelines:

- Existing agreements **do not extend** to new transactions or scopes.
- A **fresh NDA is mandatory for each new engagement**, irrespective of prior contracts.

NDA Execution Rules

- IndiGo **standard NDA template must be accepted as-is**
- **No modifications permitted at RFP stage**
- Separate NDA must be executed for **each participating vendor**
- Any deviation will lead to:
 - Delay in RFP initiation
 - Possible vendor disqualification

This ensures uniform confidentiality standards and avoids preferential treatment across vendors.

3. Compliance & Governance Mandate

All departments must strictly comply with the following:

- No vendor engagement without a **valid signed contract**
- Contract renewals must be completed **within defined timelines**
- Utilization of vendor services without active contracts is treated as:
 - Process breach
 - Code of Conduct violation

Non-compliance may result in disciplinary action as per policy.

4. Pre-RFP Requirements (Department Responsibility)

4.1 Mandatory Inputs to Governance Team

Departments must submit:

a) RFP Template (Standard Format)

- No modification allowed in structure/content
- Only blank sections to be filled
- Irrelevant sections to be marked as “N/A”

b) NDA Template

- To be filled separately for each vendor

4.2 Minimum Vendor Requirement

Standard Requirement

As part of the defined governance framework, all RFPs must ideally be conducted with a **minimum of three (3) vendors** to ensure:

- competitive benchmarking,
- transparent evaluation, and
- fair commercial comparison.

Departments are required to identify and onboard sufficient vendors prior to initiating the RFP to meet this requirement.

Deviation Handling (Less than 3 Vendors)

In cases where:

- fewer than three vendors are identified, or
- vendors drop out during the process,

the department must immediately align with Governance and Procurement to review the situation.

Based on the assessment, one of the following actions shall be taken:

- re-initiation of the RFP with adequate vendor participation, or
- continuation of the process under an approved exception.

Single Vendor RFP / RFQ (Exceptional Approval)

An RFP / RFQ may be initiated or continued with a **single vendor only under formal exceptional approval** from the designated CDIO authority or relevant approving leadership.

The following conditions are mandatory in such scenarios:

- Prior written approval must be obtained before proceeding.
- The approval must be formally documented and attached to the RFP record.
- Governance and Procurement must be explicitly informed before initiation or continuation.

This exception is to be exercised strictly on a need basis and should not be treated as a standard operating approach.

Mandatory Governance Controls (Applicable in All Cases)

Irrespective of the number of vendors, the following controls remain mandatory:

- Use of standard RFP / RFQ template without structural modification
- Execution of NDA as per defined process (where applicable)
- Procurement-led communication and vendor engagement
- Completion of InfoSec assessment based on risk classification
- Technical and functional evaluation by stakeholders
- Adherence to defined RFP milestones and timelines
- Proper documentation of evaluation outcomes and approvals
- Completion of NFA, contracting, and onboarding as per process

4.3 Vendor Registration Details

Departments must provide for each vendor:

1. Organization Name
2. Registered Address
3. Contact Person Name
4. Contact Number
5. Email Address
6. Signing Authority Details (for NDA)
7. Scope of Services

5. RFP Process Flow (Standard Sequence)

1. Define scope, objectives, and requirements in RFP template
2. Identify minimum 3 vendors
3. Execute NDA with all vendors
4. Raise Sourcing Request (SR)
5. Procurement shares RFP with vendors
6. Query resolution phase

7. Technical proposal submission
8. InfoSec evaluation (mandatory)
9. Bid defense demos
10. Technical & functional evaluation by stakeholders
11. Vendor ranking and finalization
12. NFA approval and contract execution

6. InfoSec Evaluation Framework

- InfoSec assessment is **mandatory prior to evaluation**
- Stakeholders must:
 - Determine risk level (High / Medium / Low)
 - Share appropriate questionnaire with vendor

Vendor Requirements

- Provide **complete responses with evidence**
- Attach certificates where marked “Yes”
- Incomplete submissions lead to:
 - Delays
 - Multiple back-and-forth cycles

Clear communication upfront reduces turnaround time.

7. Technical & Functional Evaluation

Evaluation will be based on:

- Technical proposal submission
- Bid defense demo
- Defined evaluation criteria

Stakeholders must:

- Prepare evaluation matrix in advance
- Rank vendors post demo

8. Bid Defense Demo Guidelines

- Demo scheduling must be:
 - Planned in advance
 - Shared with Procurement
- Avoid rescheduling:
 - Impacts vendor confidence

- Creates negative perception of governance maturity

Recommendation

- Include **InfoSec representative in demo calls**
 - Enables real-time clarification
 - Reduces post-demo delays

9. Timeline Adherence & Vendor Management

9.1 Strict Timeline Enforcement

- RFP milestones must be adhered to without deviation
- Vendors unable to meet timelines:
 - May be excluded from process

9.2 Extension Requests (Exceptional Cases Only)

In cases where:

- Vendor did not receive RFP communication
- Incorrect contact mapping occurred

Then:

- Extension may be evaluated on case-to-case basis
- Approval required from Procurement & Governance

Important Consideration

- Excessive extensions may:
 - Delay project timelines
 - Reduce vendor competition
 - Risk dropping below minimum vendor threshold

10. Query Resolution & Vendor Interaction

- Vendors may request:
 - Clarification calls
 - Scope discussions

Guidelines

- Consolidate queries centrally
- Provide structured responses

- Avoid multiple fragmented discussions

11. Communication Protocol

All RFP communications must include:

- Procurement SPOCs:
 - Gaurav Yadav
 - Ashwani Sharma

This ensures:

- Audit trail maintenance
- Process transparency

12. Common Risks & Observed Gaps

Area	Observed Issue	Impact
NDA Execution	Delays or modifications requested	RFP initiation delay
Vendor Count	Less than 3 vendors	RFP restart required
InfoSec	Incomplete submissions	Evaluation delays
Demo Scheduling	Frequent rescheduling	Vendor dissatisfaction
Timeline Ownership	Delays from requestor side	Overall project slippage
Scope Clarity	Incomplete RFP details	Increased vendor queries

13. Key Responsibilities – Department

Departments initiating RFP must ensure:

- Complete and accurate RFP documentation
- Timely NDA execution
- Vendor coordination and follow-ups
- Adherence to milestones
- Timely evaluation submission
- Alignment with Procurement and Governance

14. Final Note

RFP execution is a cross-functional process requiring strong coordination between:

- Business / Product teams
- Governance
- Procurement
- Legal
- InfoSec

Strict adherence to this process ensures:

- Faster vendor onboarding
- Compliance with organizational standards
- Efficient and transparent decision-making

If any clarification is required, stakeholders may connect with the Governance or Procurement SPOCs prior to initiating the RFP.

IndiGo RFP Process - Cross Functional Overview (Final)

